

Did you know...

Earth's outer core spins westward and at a slower rate than its inner core which spins eastward. Here's why: <http://dgit.in/1dAYOc6>

**Play Doom via piano**

A team of researchers rigged a piano to act like a keyboard for the game Doom where each key equated to a keyboard command <http://dgit.in/1b4knUV>

Buzz: Do the Social Vibe!

The parodic slogan of GTA IV's Whiz Wireless notwithstanding, last month saw some major feature updates and news from the big names in social networking

Study shows links between social media use and self-esteem

Researchers from the Media Effects Research Laboratory have conducted a study which reveals how users' profiles on social media can hint at feelings of self-esteem and self-determination.

According to the study, people with lower self-esteem are more concerned with what others post about them on Facebook and continuously monitor their Facebook walls for updates and posts. It was also found that people with high self-esteem added more information to their personal profiles on the social networks.

The study covers 225 students in a South Korean university, and is based on how the students filled in their Facebook profiles. The researchers also studied how the students edited material that friends linked to or posted on their walls. Users with both low and high self-esteem spent plenty of time building their online profiles.

Researchers found that individuals with higher self-esteem spend more time adding information about their families, education, work experience etc., while those with lower self-esteem continuously monitor their wall and delete unwanted posts from other users.

S Shyam Sundar, Professor of Communications and Co-director of the Media Effects Research Laboratory, Penn State said, "The types of actions users take and the kinds of informa-



tion they are adding to their Facebook walls and profiles are a reflection of their identities. You are your Facebook, basically, and despite all its socialness, Facebook is a deeply personal medium."

He added that this information can be useful to developers, who want to attract customers with more customisable walls and profile pages. He stated that users with both high self-esteem and low self-esteem see the social network as an extension of their self-identities and would be willing to pay for additional features on Facebook.

Facebook users have uploaded over 250 billion photos since launch

Facebook, along with Ericsson and Qualcomm, has released a white paper as part of the Internet.org project. The

paper revealed that Facebook has seen a quarter of a trillion photo uploads since the web-site's launch.

The report on Internet.org revealed that the social network sees more than 350 million photo uploads daily and has a user base of 1.15 billion. In total, Facebook users have uploaded a staggering 250 billion photos since the site came into existence. Facebook added that users share 4.75 billion "content items" per day that generate more than 4.5 billion Likes, and over 10 billion messages daily.

This number is way ahead of Facebook-owned Instagram which sees 55 million uploads daily and has a total of 16 billion uploads till date. Flickr also sees only 3.5 million photo uploads daily and has a total of 8 billion photos till date.

Facebook has recently added more features like auto-

tagging, hashtags and sharing which has made the site more user friendly. The shared photo albums feature was launched in August.

This new feature allows multiple users to upload images to a single album. The album creator can provide access to as many as 50 "contributors," who in turn can each share up to 200 photos, with up to a maximum of 1,000 photos in each album. The album creators can choose to retain control over the album or share rights with other contributors via the album settings. Right now, only three privacy settings are available for users: public, friends of contributors and contributors only.

Facebook rolls out APIs to help news organisations utilise user comments

Facebook has rolled out a set of tools that will help media and news organisations to tap into user comments and display them online or on TV.

The new tools will allow news organisations to integrate Facebook conversations in real-time and will cover data from the past few months as well. Facebook has announced additional tools – Keyword Insights API and Public Feed API – that will increase the social networking giant's position as a relevant topic simulator as well. These tools are expected to roll out in September.

The new Keyword Insights API will allow news organisations and media outlets to